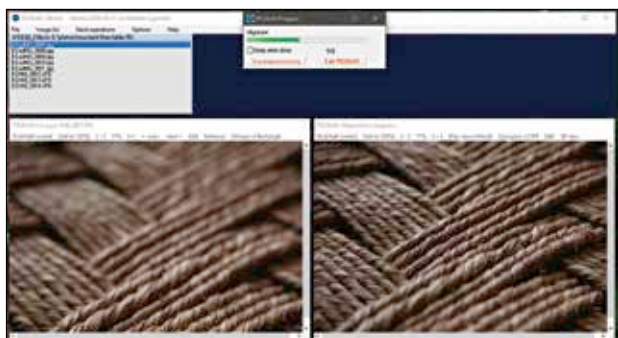
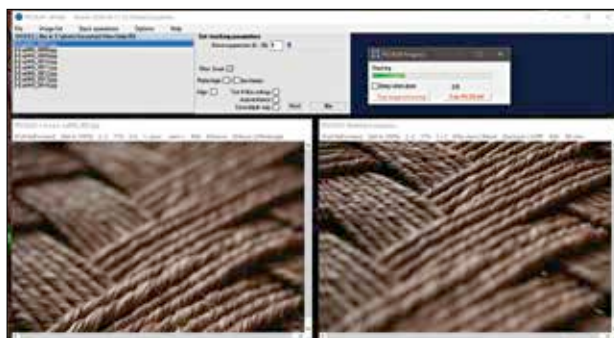




Aligning and resizing the images



Merging the images together

as white balance, and is not really going to provide great results. Once you have captured all the images that you need, we can move on to the software.

STEP 2: LOAD THE IMAGES INTO PICOLAY

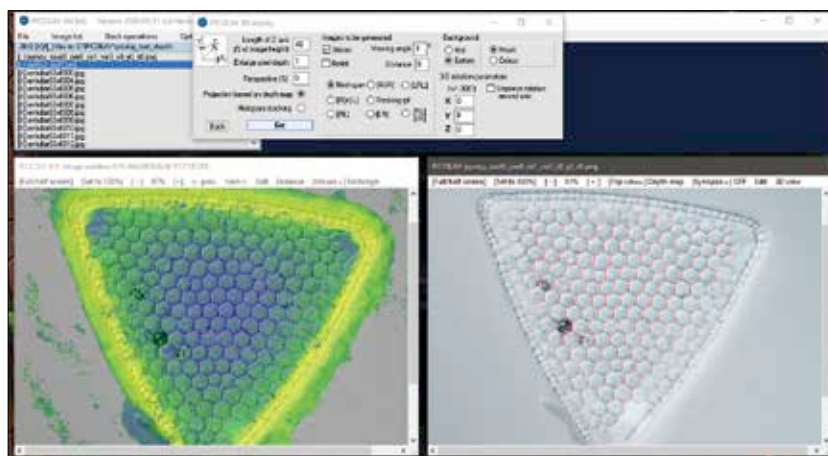
Once you have captured the images, it is better to place each "stack" of images in their own folder. This is because while you are using Picolay, the software actually generates copies of the files and stores them in the same folder. When loading images, it is convenient to pick all the images in a particular stack, without looking at the thumbnails, and you cannot really make out when a new focus stack starts if there is the same subject. There is no need to worry about the modified files, as these have a customisable prefix, and are easy to tell apart from the original photos. Placing the photos into individual folders just keeps everything optimised and simplifies the workflow. Go to File > Add Images and hold down Shift then select all the images in a particular stack. Alternatively, you can press Ctrl + A.

STEP 3: ALIGN AND RESIZE THE IMAGES

Now even if you did everything by the book in Step 1, there can still be some slight changes in the positions of the objects in the stack. This is because of focus breathing, which means that at different points of focus, certain things in the frame may appear smaller or larger in comparison to images where the focus is elsewhere. This is usually just a few pixels, and as the focus moves, the image tends to shift a little to the right or left, either upwards or downwards.

Go to Stack Operations and select Auto-align positions & resize. This is a compute intensive operation, and might take some time. Usually it is longer if there are more images in the stack. A progress bar is shown during the operation, and after the

image with everything in focus. By default, the file format is set to .jpg. If you want a different format, go to Options > Save as and change the target file format. The film is automatically saved at the end of the stacking operation. Now, go to Stack Operations



An anaglyph made using Picolay

alignment, the bottom right window will indicate that the alignment is complete. It is now finally time to make the image.

STEP 4: MERGE THE DIFFERENT IMAGES

Now is the step where you put all the images together and make one single

and select Stack with current parameters. Let the software work its magic, and your focus stacked image should be ready at the end of it. You can also go to File > Save result as to save the final image in another format.

STEP 5: MAKE AN ANAGLYPH

If you have 3D glasses lying around, you can actually use the slight changes in the focus stacking to make an anaglyphic image, from the images that you have already captured. To do this, once the stack is generated click on the 3D view in the bottom right corner, then hit Go in the new window that appears. That is it, your 3D view should now be generated. In case you have non standard 3D glasses, the options for the anaglyph can be changed in this step. 



The final output